

So we decided to work with them and also Naver.

Korea has its own digital ecosystem. So Naver is like Google – plus it has its own search engine, its own streaming platforms, etc. But they want to go outside Korea. They have been very keen on India, but they don't really have a very strong partner to expand into the market. So Krafton, Mirae Asset, and Naver decided to work together to have a common platform through which we



can invest across different industries, and then we can find strategic partners among those companies.

### How do you make BGMI even bigger than what it is right now?

**Sean Sohn:** Yes, after the regulatory issue, I feel BGMI, overall – the operational side and publishing side – has been relatively stabilized. Now we have to do more to unlock the upside, the growth potential, and the full potential of the game.

So I think this year, and maybe in the next couple of years, we will do more in terms of bringing more content – major content updates that cater to local audiences. And I believe there are certain things in our pipeline, like different game modes, which are still under development, so we cannot really announce them. But definitely, the game has matured a bit now. So we will introduce fresher,

newer, and bigger updates to the game in the coming one or two years.

### You acquired Nautilus Mobile and became a majority shareholder. Any more collaboration opportunities among Indian gamemakers?

**Sean Sohn:** Nautilus is a big milestone for us because there has been a lot of inquiry from the media and from gamers about why we don't make a game from India. So Nautilus is one of the ways we want to address those questions. It's also a question to ourselves: how can we do more to make a game from India?

We made an investment in Nautilus almost four years back because we were interested in cricket games. We tried to find the best game developers in the country, and they were available for investment. So we invested, nurtured the partnership, and found that they have been gradually improving their game development capacity. We believe that if we become a majority shareholder, we can help them grow faster.

While we are doing this through the acquisition, investment, and publishing partnership, we also set up a small team that is going to make a new game for Indian audiences, with a focus on Indian audiences. If things go in the right direction, probably within a year or so, we may announce a new game from our internal team.

### What is so special about the Indian esports landscape, and what's your role in driving esports growth?

**Sean Sohn:** We believe Battle Royale in general – especially PUBG on the PC side and on the mobile side – and especially BGMI, is very suitable for the esports format. So we have

heavily invested in esports across different platforms for the last seven to eight years. Even though we cannot really make it profitable, we believe in the value of esports for BGMI and its IP.

We will continue to do whatever we can with BGMI, and we also communicate with the right stakeholders – from the government side and other third parties we partner with. In the coming years, especially starting from 2026, we will try to create more exposure for Indian players to play internationally. We will try our best to invite global players to play in India, as we did in 2025, and we will find more opportunities to send Indian teams to play outside as well.

### How are you making gaming more inclusive in India?

**Sean Sohn:** There has been a disparity or disconnect between generations and between different demographics. In gaming-wise developed countries like Korea, there is almost equal representation between female and male gamers. In India, it's more disproportionate.

But I think in India, the mature generation is afraid of gaming rather than trying to find ways to balance gaming and other parts of life. I'm trying my best – I share my ideas on how to do it as a parent.

We have also done certain CSR initiatives. They haven't become very big, but we will continue to address this issue from a CSR point of view. And I think, as a gaming company, it's a responsible approach: you should not just try to make a business out of it; you should also cultivate the culture around it. So I can give my personal commitment that we have been trying to find ways to contribute in this manner, and we will do more.

### What lessons are you learning in Indian gaming, and how is it informing Krafton globally?

**Sean Sohn:** India has been the